

'Dell Pro Essential's available with Intel and AMD chips'

And they're aimed at small and medium businesses, says Dell Senior Director **Indrajit Belgundi**

Divyanshi Sharma | editor@digit.in

Dell has long built a diverse laptop portfolio that caters to every kind of user. There are gamers who rely on Alienware for top-tier performance, creators who prefer the sleek design of XPS, students using Inspiron for everyday tasks, and professionals depending on Latitude for work.

'SMBs (small businesses) and MBs (medium businesses) are the engines that drive the economy,' said Indrajit Belgundi, Senior Director & General Manager, Client Solutions Group, Dell Technologies India. Having been a part of the company for over two decades, Belgundi took immense pride in talking about Dell's latest offerings: the Dell Pro 14 Essential and Dell Pro 15 Essential laptops. Available with Intel or AMD processors and starting at Rs 31,999, the series combines portability with full-size functionality, while integrating business-focused features.

Indrajit Belgundi, in an exclusive conversation with Digit, spoke about the new laptops, the SME landscape in India, the growing interest in AI-powered devices, and more. Here are excerpts from the conversation.

Q Dell has introduced the Pro 14 and Pro 15 Essential series aimed squarely at MSMEs. What was the core idea behind creating these devices, and how do they stand

apart from Dell's regular consumer or business laptops?

A Indrajit Belgundi:

From Dell Technologies' standpoint, we are very excited and proud to launch the Dell Pro Essential 14-inch and 15-inch in India. These products are designed specially for small and medium-sized business customers. Many of these clients, including startups, want the right device with the right features. And by 'right features', I mean ensuring that the device is secure, reliable, and easy to manage, without compromising on the essentials. This is where Dell takes pride, as we continuously engage with customers and incorporate their feedback. The Dell Pro Essential series is available with both Intel and AMD processors, includes hardware TPM for security, is MIL-STD tested for reliability, and comes with Dell Management Suite and additional Windows features like Autopilot.

Q When designing these laptops, what were some of the biggest takeaways from Indian SMEs/MSMEs? Were there any needs or challenges that directly shaped the features you're offering?

A Indrajit Belgundi: SB and MB

customers want the right features at the right price point. They don't want to compromise on pricing or features, but they need a device that meets their requirements now and in the foreseeable future.

For example, many customers have mentioned that although standard warranty usually covers one year, they would prefer devices with five-year warranties as standard. It may seem small, but it's very important. Typically, consumers go with one or three-year warranties, but enterprise customers prefer five years. For SMBs, we want to ensure the total cost of ownership is optimised and features like extended warranty are available.



Indrajit Belgundi
Senior Director & General
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Q What impact do you think AI PCs will have on productivity for Indian businesses and MSMEs?

A Indrajit Belgundi: When we speak about AI PCs, we need to consider the entire AI ecosystem. Many processors are now AI-ready. Microsoft has also come up with Copilot Plus, which enhances system performance. Many applications are now AI-ready, including CrowdStrike, Microsoft Teams, and others, fine-tuning their software for AI.

We believe that by 2028, around 98% of devices will be AI-enabled. This will improve productivity in multiple ways. Typically, an AI PC has three components: CPU, GPU, and NPU. In an AI PC, the key component is the NPU, which fine-tunes applications and offloads work from the CPU. This also helps improve battery life and system performance. **D**

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